

Andrew Chuang: We can see that more and more professionals tend to take their notebooks outside and we've also seen that with the whole 'work from home' culture that's prevalent due to Covid-19, a lot of people had to move their work PCs to home. That's why we created the new Enduro rugged lineup of rugged notebooks, tablets and semi-rugged notebooks which are not only rugged but also thin and light for daily usage.

d We couldn't help but notice that most of the products announced during Next@Acer were based on Intel and NVIDIA hardware. Now that AMD also has very competitive CPUs, would we see more products from Acer using AMD hardware?

James Lin: Acer works with a lot of platform partners. Not only Intel but also AMD. Also, in our Chromebooks, we also have SKUs based on not only Intel x86 parts but also non-x86 parts. AMD is our good partner and we also have a lot of products based on AMD platforms. We know AMD is currently experiencing a very good growth which we are very much enjoying right now.

Of course, we are continually evaluating AMD's platform technologies. However, there are some things

that we still consider would be challenges. In gaming, we found that the major usage with regards to processor technology happens to be with single-threaded performance. In single threaded performance, we see that AMD CPUs have not caught up to Intel although they've come very close. And



Acer's new Enduro lineup

in some of our testing we did see that better single-threaded CPU performance results in better gaming experience. So we are continually evaluating and expecting the next generation of platforms from both companies to be at par. So we'll keep watching AMD and Intel's technologies.

d We recently saw Apple's recent announcement to migrate from the x86 architecture towards their own ARM

silicon. Does Acer also have similar plans to focus on ARM as a more viable platform for notebooks and desktops or are you going to primarily focus on x86?

James Lin: I think that it's a very phenomenal announcement from Apple. When we look into why Apple is indulg-

ing in this kind of behaviour, you need to go into their history.

Apple and Intel once had a discussion about some customisation requirements within the processor. First time, they didn't make the customisation and the second time around, they did make it. Now was the third time so Apple decided on the change.

Coming to ARM, Acer has already been using ARM for a while. We had the first Chromebook designed with a MediaTek solution based on ARM. So we are familiar with ARM, however, the Windows environment is very complicated and we try to identify markets where we can use it. We know that a lot of the usage models under development are taking place under the Linux environment such as programming or coding and there are applications that need a wider instruction set. But if you try to address this market with ARM, it's not easy. So we continue to watch this space and evaluate ARM's architecture under Qualcomm or MTK. These ARM architectures are not mature enough to replace the x86 Windows environments, yet. You can see that Microsoft tried this with the Surface Pro X. Although there is revenue from the ARM platforms, the growth is very limited. We'll continue to develop the software to make the platform mature, however, with regards to the hardware we'll still have to wait for it to mature. **d**



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